Overview of the NTCIR-19 FEHU Task: Fact-based Event-centric Human-value Understanding

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ABSTRACT

This paper provides an overview of the NTCIR-19 **FEHU** (Fact-based Event-centric Human-value Understanding) task. FEHU evaluates whether systems can identify the human values associated with specific actors in factual English news and, for fine-grained values, determine whether the actor's described conduct is aligned with or contradictory to each value. The task comprises four multi-label subtasks that combine two semantic scopes, full articles and sentence-level subevents, with two label settings: 20 coarse Level-2 categories without direction and 54 detailed Level-1 values with aligned or contradictory directions. Across all task-specific release files, the collection contains 1,755 article records and 13,964 subevents. The Task-1 and Task-2 test sets each contain 175 articles, with no overlap between the two sets. During the formal run, multiple submissions were allowed. Two teams submitted four evaluated run packages: WAIPS submitted three packages for Task-1, and IIUoT submitted one package covering Task-1 and Task-2. The best participant Micro-F1 scores are 70.42, 59.79, 52.33, and 46.68 for Tasks 1a, 1b, 2a, and 2b, respectively. We describe the task specification, collection construction, released data, submission and evaluation protocols, submitted runs, organizer baseline, and official formal-run results.

KEYWORDS

human value understanding, factual news, actor-conditioned recognition, event-centric evaluation, shared task, NTCIR-19, FEHU

1 INTRODUCTION

Human values are normative principles that guide how individuals and societies evaluate actions, decisions, and social outcomes [1]. Recognizing such values in factual news is not equivalent to detecting an explicitly stated opinion. A news article may describe several individuals, institutions, governments, companies, or social groups, while value-relevant evidence is distributed across actions, reported speech, institutional responses, and consequences. A system must therefore identify not only *which* value is implicated, but also *which actor* it concerns and, where required, whether the actor's conduct is aligned with or contradictory to that value.

Computational research has made human values measurable in arguments, dialogues, situation descriptions, and model-oriented evaluation settings [2–6]. These resources establish useful taxonomies and supervised evaluation protocols, but their instances are typically shorter and more self-contained than factual news reports. News introduces additional attribution and scope problems: several actors may participate in the same account, relevant cues may be implicit, and the same value may be realized by one actor while being violated by another. Consequently, assigning one undifferentiated label set to an entire article does not reveal whether a system has grounded a value in the appropriate evidence or attributed it to the correct actor.

Event-centric news research provides a complementary foundation for addressing this problem. Work on news narrative extraction, document-level event extraction, and event-centered benchmarks has shown the importance of decomposing long documents into localized events and modeling their relations [7–9]. Research on quotation attribution and news framing further demonstrates that interpretation depends on who performs or reports an action and how agency, responsibility, and perspective are represented [10, 11]. These findings motivate an evaluation setting that combines event-localized evidence with explicit actor conditioning and value direction.

The NTCIR-19 FEHU task is derived from the NEVU benchmark [12] and evaluates actor-conditioned human value recognition at two semantic scopes: complete articles and sentence-grounded subevents. FEHU defines four multi-label subtasks by crossing these scopes with two label settings: 20 coarse-grained Level-2 values without direction and 54 fine-grained Level-1 values with aligned or contradictory direction. Training and development articles contain both scopes, whereas the official Task-1 and Task-2 test inputs

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Table 1: Timeline of the NTCIR-19 FEHU task.

Date	Event
September 2025	Task announcement and sample data release (kick-off)
November 2025	Trial data release for small-scale debugging
January 2026	Final training data release and dry run
March–June 2026	Formal run; multiple submissions allowed
August 2026	Evaluation results returned and task overview released
September 2026	Participant paper submission due
October 2026	Notification to authors
November 2026	Camera-ready submission due
December 8–10, 2026	NTCIR-19 Conference, Tokyo, Japan

Table 2: Teams with valid formal-run submissions. A run denotes one evaluated ZIP submission package.

Team	Institution	Tasks	Runs
WAIPS	Waseda University, Japan	Task-1	3
IIUoT	University of Tsukuba, Japan	Task-1, Task-2	1
Total: 2 teams			**4**

are drawn from separate, non-overlapping article sets. The task resources, examples, and evaluator are distributed through the official repository.[1]

Of three registered teams, two submitted valid formal-run outputs. Because multiple submissions were allowed, the organizers received four evaluated run packages: three Task-1 packages from WAIPS and one package from IIUoT covering Task-1 and Task-2. This yielded four participant outputs for each article-level subtask and one participant output for each subevent-level subtask. Tables 1 and 2 summarize the task schedule and participating teams.

The sample and trial releases introduced the data schema and supported system debugging. The January release provided the final training data together with a dry run for testing the submission pipeline, followed by the official evaluation period from March through June 2026.

The remainder of this paper is organized as follows. Section 2 defines the four subtasks and evaluation measures. Section 3 describes the test collection, released files, submission format, and submitted runs. Section 4 reports the official formal-run results, and Section 5 concludes the paper.

2 TASK

2.1 Task Specification

Let $g \in \mathcal{G}$ denote a factual news article, $\mathcal{A}^{(g)}$ its released list of main actors, and $\mathcal{E}^{(g)}$ its set of subevents. A subevent $e \in \mathcal{E}^{(g)}$ is a localized event description grounded in the source article. For an article–actor pair (g, a) or a subevent–actor tuple (g, e, a), a system predicts a set of human value labels. The taxonomy contains a fine-grained Level-1 label set $\mathcal{V}^{(1)}$ with 54 values and a coarse Level-2 label set $\mathcal{V}^{(2)}$ with 20 categories. Each Level-1 value maps to one Level-2 category.

For the direction-aware subtasks, each prediction is a pair (v, d), where $v \in \mathcal{V}^{(1)}$ and $d \in \{\textsc{Aligned}, \textsc{Contradictory}\}$. Aligned indicates that the actor's behavior, speech, position, or described outcome supports or realizes the value in the evaluated scope. Contradictory indicates a violation, denial, obstruction, or adverse outcome with respect to the value. Direction is assigned separately to each actor–value pair within the evaluated article or subevent, rather than to the text as a whole.

[1] https://github.com/ii-research/NTCIR-19-FEHU-resource

Table 3: The four FEHU subtasks. Each is evaluated as a multi-label prediction problem.

Task	Scope	Required output tuple	Measures
1a	Article	`guid, actor, l2_value`	Micro/Macro-F1
1b	Article	`guid, actor, l1_value, direction`	Micro/Macro-F1, DRR
2a	Subevent	`guid, subevent_id, actor, l2_value`	Micro/Macro-F1
2b	Subevent	`guid, subevent_id, actor, l1_value, direction`	Micro/Macro-F1, DRR

Task-1: Article-level Human Value Recognition. Systems receive the article identifier, title, full article content, the released actor list, and the value taxonomy. The objective is to identify the values associated with each actor at the article level, with the actor set intended to cover actors appearing across the article's subevents. Task-1a predicts Level-2 values without direction, whereas Task-1b predicts directed Level-1 values. The evaluation instance is (`guid`, `actor`). Because evidence for one actor may be distributed across the document, systems must condition their predictions on the target actor rather than assigning a single value set to the article.

Task-2: Subevent-level Human Value Recognition. Systems additionally receive a subevent identifier and subevent text together with the article's released actor list. Because no separate actor list is supplied for each subevent, systems determine the values associated with each released actor in that localized context. Task-2a predicts directionless Level-2 values, whereas Task-2b predicts directed Level-1 values. Each evaluation instance is identified by the tuple (`guid`, `subevent_id`, `actor`). Subevents provide more localized evidence than articles, but may contain fewer contextual cues, implicit consequences, or role-based actor references. Training and development data permit comparisons between the article and subevent scopes on shared articles. In the formal test, however, Task-1 and Task-2 use separate article sets, so cross-task score differences are descriptive rather than controlled scope comparisons.

2.2 Evaluation Measures

Micro-F1. True positives, false positives, and false negatives are accumulated over all evaluation instances:

$$\text{Micro-P} = \frac{\text{TP}}{\text{TP} + \text{FP}}, \qquad \text{Micro-R} = \frac{\text{TP}}{\text{TP} + \text{FN}}, \tag{1}$$

$$\text{Micro-F1} = \frac{2\,\text{Micro-P}\,\text{Micro-R}}{\text{Micro-P} + \text{Micro-R}}. \tag{2}$$

Macro-F1. Let $\mathcal{L}$ denote the task-specific label space, and let $\mathcal{L}_{\text{gold}}$ denote the subset of labels that occur at least once in the gold data. For each label $\ell \in \mathcal{L}_{\text{gold}}$, label-wise F1 is computed as

$$\text{F1}_\ell = \frac{2\,\text{TP}_\ell}{2\,\text{TP}_\ell + \text{FP}_\ell + \text{FN}_\ell}, \tag{3}$$

where TP_ℓ, FP_ℓ, and FN_ℓ are the true-positive, false-positive, and false-negative counts for label ℓ. Gold-supported Macro-F1 is then defined as

$$\mathrm{DRR} = \frac{N_{\mathrm{rev}}}{N_{\mathrm{gold,unique}}}, \tag{4}$$

where N_{rev} is the number of direction-unique gold instance–value pairs for which the prediction includes the opposite direction, and $N_{\mathrm{gold,unique}}$ is the total number of gold instance–value pairs with a unique direction. If both directions occur in the gold annotations for the same instance and value, that pair is excluded from both counts. Lower DRR is better. A missed gold value remains in the denominator but does not count as a reversal; DRR should therefore be interpreted together with F1.

Direction Reverse Rate. For Task-1b and Task-2b, FEHU additionally reports Direction Reverse Rate (DRR). For each evaluation instance, a Level-1 value is excluded from this metric if it appears with both directions in the gold annotations. Among the remaining direction-unique gold values, a reversal occurs when the prediction includes the same value identity with the opposite direction.

$$\mathrm{DRR} = \frac{N_{\mathrm{rev}}}{N_{\mathrm{gold,unique}}}, \tag{5}$$

where N_{rev} is the number of direction-unique gold instance–value pairs for which the prediction includes the opposite direction, and $N_{\mathrm{gold,unique}}$ is the total number of gold instance–value pairs with a unique direction. If both directions occur in the gold annotations for the same instance and value, that pair is excluded from both counts. Lower DRR is better.

3 COLLECTION CONSTRUCTION AND RUN SUBMISSION

3.1 Source Corpus, Subevents, and Actors

The FEHU collection is drawn from the NEVU news corpus [12]. It combines English news items sampled from the UKNow resource [13] with English Wikinews stories collected to broaden temporal and topical coverage. Candidate records were filtered and cleaned to remove corrupted, duplicated, overly short, and unsuitable articles. The FEHU subset in the official release contains 1,755 factual English article records across the training, development, and task-specific test files. The 1,405 training and development records contain both article- and subevent-level inputs; the two test files each contain 175 articles and have disjoint `guid` sets.

Each article is assigned a globally unique identifier (`guid`), segmented into sentences, and represented at multiple event scopes in the underlying resource. The FEHU formal task releases only the full Article and sentence-grounded Subevents. A subevent is a concise description of a coherent local event linked to the source article. Main social actors are identified and canonicalized so that aliases and varying surface forms can be evaluated under stable actor strings. Actors may be individuals, organizations, institutions, governments, companies, or social groups.

3.2 Human Value Labels

FEHU uses the hierarchical taxonomy introduced for computational human value recognition [2], containing 54 Level-1 values grouped into 20 Level-2 categories. The release provides the Level-1 and Level-2 label files, the complete hierarchy, deterministic mappings between the levels, and the direction mapping used by the official data. Train and development records additionally contain explanations supporting actor-conditioned labels; explanations may be used for system development but are not evaluated.

The labels originate from the staged LLM-assisted annotation and verification procedure described in the NEVU paper [12]. Candidate actor–value–direction tuples were proposed by heterogeneous language models, low-confidence candidates were subjected to evidence-grounded verification, and unresolved cases were sent to targeted human review. The final annotations were normalized and deduplicated per evaluation instance. In validation of the underlying resource, 92.7% of sampled article-level and 88.6% of sampled subevent-level candidate directed labels were majority-confirmed, providing an empirical indication of annotation reliability at both evaluation scopes.

Table 4: Event-base statistics for the official FEHU release. The Task-1 and Task-2 test files contain disjoint articles.

Split / scope	Articles	Subevents	Article–actor pairs	Subevent–actor pairs
Train	1,228	10,822	3,381	30,543
Dev	177	1,526	459	3,998
Test Task-1	175	0	479	0
Test Task-2	175	1,616	444	4,126
All files	1,755	13,964	4,763	38,667

3.3 Data Splits and Released Files

The training and development releases contain both complete articles and their sentence-grounded subevents. The formal test inputs are released separately by task rather than as two views of one unified test partition: `test_article_event_base.json` contains 175 article-level records for Task-1, whereas `test_subevent_event_base.json` contains 175 different article records and 1,616 subevents for Task-2. The two test files have no overlapping `guids`.

Table 4 reports statistics computed from the released event-base files. Article–actor pairs count the released actor identifiers for each article. Because the event-base files do not provide a separate actor list for each subevent, Subevent–actor pairs are counted as the number of subevents multiplied by the number of released article actors within each article. These Subevent–actor counts therefore represent candidate tuples induced by the released schema rather than gold-positive actor–value instances.

Table 5 reports the gold annotations released for training and development. For Tasks 1a and 2a, the counts are unique Level-2 assignments per evaluation instance; for Tasks 1b and 2b, they are unique directed Level-1 assignments. Across the two splits, the annotations cover all 54 Level-1 values and all 20 Level-2 values at both the Article and Subevent scopes; the development split alone contains 51 Level-1 values in each scope. A total of 3,791 Article–actor instances and 14,536 Subevent–actor instances have at least one gold annotation. Directed labels are more often Aligned than Contradictory: 13,053 versus 6,242 at the Article level and 15,135 versus 6,298 at the Subevent level.

Table 5: Gold-label statistics for the released training and development data. Counts are unique label assignments per evaluation instance.

Split	Task-1a L2	Task-1b directed L1	Task-2a L2	Task-2b directed L1
Train	13,371	16,905	17,881	18,665
Dev	1,861	2,390	2,619	2,768
Train + Dev	15,232	19,295	20,500	21,433

Each event-base article record provides an identifier (`guid`), a title, the article content, and the released actor list. Task-2 records additionally provide a list of subevents; each localized event has an `id` and `subevent` field. Training and development gold records contain `article_human_values` and `subevents_human_values`; each actor-centric annotation stores the actor, Level-1 value, Level-2 value, direction, and explanation. The participant release does not include test gold labels, so test label counts are not reported here.

A data correction was issued on March 20, 2026. Versions before commit `af52dcb` contained actor misalignment in the train and development gold files due to a code bug. Participants and reproducibility studies should use the corrected commit or a later release.

3.4 Submission Format and Submitted Runs

Participants submitted task-specific JSON prediction files using the schemas provided in the official repository. Task-1 outputs are indexed by article identifier and actor, whereas Task-2 outputs additionally include the subevent identifier. Actor strings and identifiers were required to match the released inputs exactly. The official evaluator reports Micro-F1 and Macro-F1 for all subtasks and DRR for Tasks 1b and 2b.

WAIPS submitted three runs for Task-1, while IIUoT submitted one run covering both Task-1 and Task-2. The corresponding results are reported in Tables 6 and 7.

3.5 Organizer Baseline

The organizer baseline was constructed by applying LoRA fine-tuning to `meta-llama/Llama-3.1-8B-Instruct` [14] using the official FEHU training data. A single unified model was trained on both article- and subevent-level instances. For each instance, the input prompt specified the evaluation scope, the corresponding article or subevent text, the target actor, and the Level-1 value taxonomy. The model generated two sets of Level-1 values in JSON format, representing values aligned with and contradictory to the target actor. Directionless Level-2 predictions were obtained by deterministically mapping and deduplicating the predicted Level-1 values.

LoRA was applied to the query, key, value, and output projection layers with rank $r = 16$, LoRA scaling parameter $\alpha = 32$, and dropout 0.05. The model was trained for six epochs with a learning rate of 2×10^{-4}, a batch size of 2, gradient accumulation over eight steps, and a maximum sequence length of 4,096 tokens. The checkpoint with the highest Level-1 Overall Micro-F1 on the development set was used for final evaluation. Inference used deterministic decoding with a maximum of 128 generated tokens.

The protected test labels were used only for final scoring. The organizer baseline is reported as an unranked reference system and was not included in the official participant ranking.

Table 6: Official Task-1 results (%). Higher F1 and lower DRR are better. The organizer baseline is shown for reference and is excluded from the participant ranking.

Panel A: Task-1a

System	Run	Micro-F1	Macro-F1
Organizer Baseline	–	67.82	54.05
IIUoT	01	**70.42**	**58.08**
WAIPS	02	69.30	56.46
WAIPS	03	68.62	57.05
WAIPS	01	65.89	53.66

Panel B: Task-1b

System	Run	Micro-F1	Macro-F1	DRR↓
Organizer Baseline	–	62.84	44.02	3.86
IIUoT	01	**59.79**	39.30	6.13
WAIPS	03	58.08	**39.52**	4.77
WAIPS	01	55.43	32.77	**3.45**
WAIPS	02	54.96	35.80	3.95

4 OFFICIAL RESULTS

The official evaluator outputs are reported in Tables 6 and 7. Scores are multiplied by 100 and rounded to two decimal places. Participant runs are ordered by Micro-F1. Boldface marks the best participant result in each metric column. The organizer baseline is shown separately as an unranked reference and is excluded from the official participant ranking. Micro-F1 is the primary ranking measure, while Macro-F1 and DRR are reported as complementary diagnostics.

4.1 Task-1 Results

Among the participant runs, IIUoT-01 achieves the highest Task-1a Micro-F1 and Macro-F1, at 70.42 and 58.08, respectively. The organizer baseline obtains 67.82 Micro-F1 and 54.05 Macro-F1 on the same subtask.

For Task-1b, IIUoT-01 achieves the highest participant Micro-F1 (59.79), WAIPS-03 achieves the highest participant Macro-F1 (39.52), and WAIPS-01 records the lowest participant DRR (3.45). For reference, the organizer baseline obtains 62.84 Micro-F1, 44.02 Macro-F1, and a DRR of 3.86. Among the participant runs, the run with the strongest F1 is not the run with the lowest DRR, showing that directed-label recovery and direction-reversal errors capture related but distinct aspects of system performance.

The three WAIPS runs show different performance profiles. WAIPS-02 performs best among the WAIPS runs on Task-1a, whereas WAIPS-03 obtains the strongest WAIPS Micro-F1 and Macro-F1 on Task-1b. WAIPS-01 has the lowest participant DRR on Task-1b. Thus, no single WAIPS run dominates across all measures.

4.2 Task-2 Results

IIUoT-01 is the only participant submission for Task-2 and therefore provides the official participant result for both Task-2a and Task-2b. It outperforms the organizer baseline in Micro-F1 and Macro-F1

Table 7: Official Task-2 results (%). Higher F1 and lower DRR are better.

System	Run	Task-2a		Task-2b		
		Micro-F1	Macro-F1	Micro-F1	Macro-F1	DRR↓
Organizer Baseline	–	38.02	27.09	35.33	23.44	0.71
IIUoT	01	**52.33**	**39.24**	**46.68**	**26.96**	1.16

on both subtasks. The organizer baseline records a lower DRR, but also substantially lower F1, again showing that DRR should be interpreted together with label-recovery performance. Because only one team participated in Task-2, no cross-team ranking is available for these subtasks.

4.3 Cross-Task Observations

Across the four participant Task-1 runs, Task-1a consistently yields higher Micro-F1 and Macro-F1 than Task-1b. The Micro-F1 difference ranges from 10.46 to 14.34 percentage points, while the Macro-F1 difference ranges from 17.53 to 20.89 points. This pattern is consistent with the additional complexity of predicting 54 fine-grained values together with their directions, compared with predicting 20 coarse-grained categories without direction. The relatively low Task-1b DRR values (3.45–6.13) further indicate that direction reversal accounts for only part of the performance gap; missed values, unsupported predictions, and fine-grained label confusion also contribute.

For IIUoT-01, the reported article-level Micro-F1 is higher than its subevent-level Micro-F1 by 18.09 points in the coarse-label tasks (Task-1a versus Task-2a) and by 13.11 points in the directed-label tasks (Task-1b versus Task-2b). At the same time, its Task-2b DRR is lower than its Task-1b DRR (1.16 versus 6.13). However, the official Task-1 and Task-2 test files contain disjoint article sets, so these differences conflate semantic scope with test-set composition and should not be treated as a controlled Article-versus-Subevent comparison. The lower Task-2b DRR nevertheless illustrates why DRR and F1 must be read together: a run may reverse direction less often while still missing or misclassifying more values overall. Broader conclusions require either matched-scope evaluation on the same articles or additional participant systems.

5 CONCLUSIONS

This paper reported the task design and official formal-run results of the NTCIR-19 FEHU task for actor-conditioned human value recognition in factual English news. FEHU provides article- and subevent-level evaluation under both a 20-category directionless setting and a 54-value direction-aware setting. The main observations are as follows:

- Two teams submitted four evaluated run packages: three Task-1 packages from WAIPS and one Task-1/Task-2 package from IIUoT.
- Among participant runs, IIUoT-01 achieves the best Micro-F1 on Task-1a and Task-1b, while WAIPS-03 obtains the best Task-1b Macro-F1 and WAIPS-01 the lowest Task-1b DRR. The unranked organizer baseline provides an additional reference point for interpreting these results.
- Participant runs consistently achieve higher F1 on coarse Level-2 recognition than on fine-grained directed Level-1 recognition, while direction reversal accounts for only part of the observed performance gap.
- For the only participant run covering both Task-1 and Task-2, article-level F1 is higher and subevent-level DRR is lower. Because the two test sets contain disjoint articles, this remains a descriptive cross-task observation rather than a controlled scope comparison.

FEHU is a diagnostic benchmark for evidence-grounded, actor-sensitive news understanding. Its labels should not be interpreted as exhaustive or uniquely correct moral judgments about real actors, and broader conclusions about task difficulty will require additional systems and future evaluation rounds.

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